



Converting Old Radio into a Bluetooth Speaker

by [MadisKa](#) on July 8, 2014

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I'm 24 year old technology enthusiast from Estonia with a interest in all things related to engineering & design. I have been educated in Estonia, South-Korea and Norway. I have a wide range of knowledge and skills related to teacher education, design and engineering. I'm always interested in new projects and collaborating with others.

Intro: Converting Old Radio into a Bluetooth Speaker

I had this cool looking Soviet Russian transistor radio Neywa 402 (made in 70s) on my shelf for a year. It was nice to look at and had a sentimental value but it didn't work. So I decided to give it a new life as a vintage bluetooth audio speaker.



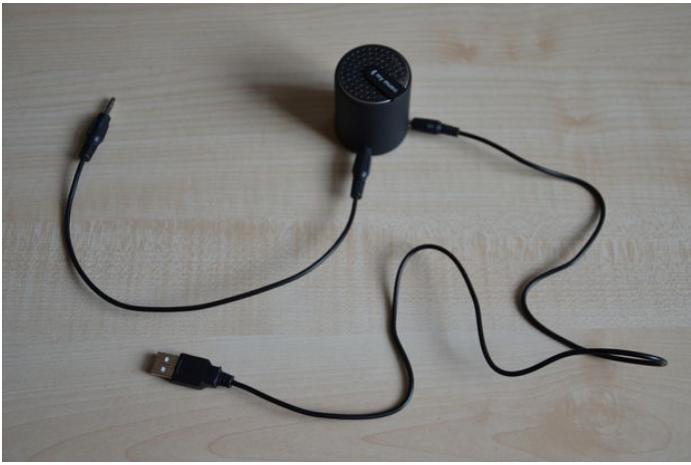
Step 1: What You Need

You need:

A radio - You can make almost any radio to work with bluetooth but I think smaller is better.

A bluetooth speaker - I bought mine from ebay, they cost about 10 USD with shipping.





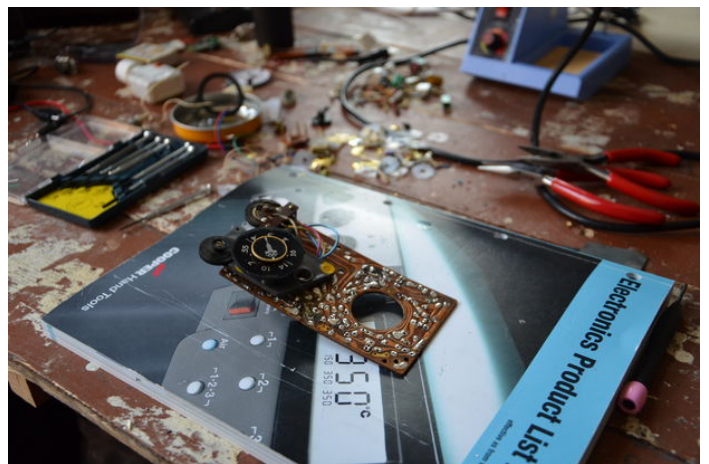
Step 2: Bluetooth speaker disassembly

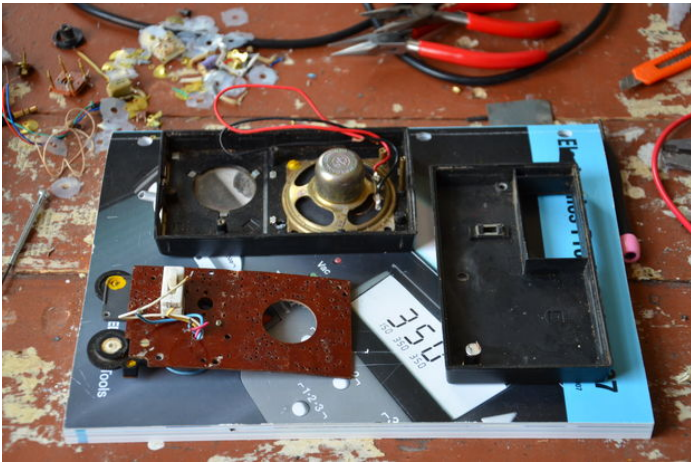
It is quite simple. Just take out the screws from the bluetooth speaker, disconnect the two actual speaker wires and you will have a bluetooth board with battery.



Step 3: Radio disassembly

Just take out the screws, desolder the elements from the circuit board but leave one switch or button so you can use it for switching the bluetooth speaker battery ON and OFF later.





Step 4: Assembly

Solder the wires of the original speaker inside the radio to the bluetooth speaker contacts on the board. The bluetooth speaker came with a USB charging cable so connect that in to the connector on the bluetooth board (so you can recharge the device).

One extra possibility: It also came with a audio cable - cut it and but the jack in to the connector on the BL board and connect the three wires from it to the female jack (and attache the female jack to the radio enclosure). The good news is that now you can attach the radio to any device with a regular audio cable and the bad news is that in order to flip the switch from bluetooth mode to jack mode, you need to take the radio apart.

One of the original switches on the radio can be wired between the battery and the bluetooth board so it will work as a ON/OFF switch (light blue wires on the picture).

The charging cable of the USB can be placed discreetly to the radio battery bay and the letter radio enclosure will cover it nicely.

More Info:

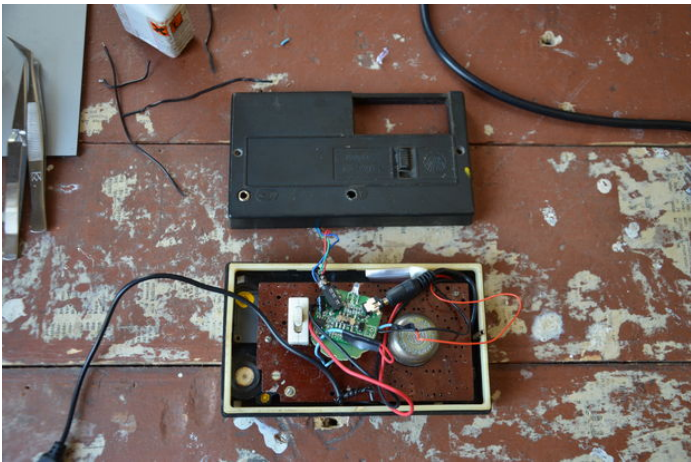
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Related Instructables



Re-purposing an Antique Portable Radio Into a Hip Bluetooth Speaker by ke4mcl



Antique Radio as Bluetooth Speaker by dermbrian



Bring a Vintage GI Joe Walkie-Talkie Back to Life with Bluetooth! by mazzmn



Vintage Radio Guitar Amp by lonesoulsurfer



Undestructible Way Of Converting Old Music System Into Bluetooth Wireless System, Internet Radio, Piano, Guitar Etc, Movie Theatre, Andriod, Iphone Enabled by dwsworks



1955 Sears Silvertone Radio Converted to Speaker Cabinet (Photos) by Grunambulax

Comments